



Security Watch

"Clickjacking" The Coming Threat?

A new security threat is emerging in the form of "clickjacking".

This relies upon a combination of security flaws that have been discovered in both Web sites and in browsers.

Because of these flaws, a user could be made to click on a link that is perhaps invisible, or only visible briefly; that would then take them to a forged Web site, a fake bank site, and so forth, in which they may well enter personal information and fall victim to a phishing attack.

The details of this new kind of attack were due to be released at the recent OWASP conference, but the speakers withdrew at the last moment in the interests of "responsible disclosure".

They said that the flaws they had discovered were so serious, that they should first inform the vendors concerned before they made the flaws public – this would hopefully limit the number of people able to mount attacks before the flaws are corrected.

The problems concerned apparently apply to "Web sites in general", but as addressing these would take enormous time and effort, the best defense would lie in encouraging browser vendors to fix the problems in their software.

For more information about clickjacking, you should visit:

<http://hackers.org/blog/20080915/clickjacking/>

uneasiness of the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI). TRAI started looking into the security of the Wi-Fi networks after the terror e-mails post the Ahmedabad blasts – so did everybody. The TRAI considered implementing laws that banned all kinds of open Wi-Fi networks. BMC however defended their plans by saying that authentication, monitoring and logging of all users would prevent abuse of the networks. The BMC plans to implement the Wi-Fi infrastructure with intrusion detectors, and protection of user accounts from being hacked. If the project is implemented, there will be an independent cell like the cyber crime unit to police all activity on the Wi-Fi network.

However there will always be people who abuse the existing infrastructure. The TRAI is not worried only about BMC's plans, there are many free Wi-Fi zones already in the city, and it is possible to drive down the road and detect unsecured Wi-Fi zones from many places. People who use Wi-Fi at home don't take the trouble to secure it for the most part. Stalling the implementation of a clearly useful plan just because of possible terrorist activity, will stop in its tracks all the benefits of such a network.

Security is not the only issue the BMC is grappling with. There are a number of implementations problems as well, the city covers an area of more than 470 sq kilometres. Setting up a Wi-Fi zone across the entire city, monitoring each and every user account, and keeping the setup running would be a big problem. There are also subscription

problems, the methods by which the BMC will bear the cost of the service for example. There are also questions about freeloaders. Controlling the use of such a large network is quite a problem.

GREEN GOT GREENER

LED Screen Laptops From Dell

Following up on the eco-friendliness after going carbon neutral, one of the greenest tech companies around has announced that beginning in December, it will start offering LED-lit displays on their laptops instead of the mercury based cold cathode fluorescent backlighting.

The LED backlighting apart from saving power (estimated to cumulate upto 220 million kilowatt-hours by 2010), will also offer a better lighting and contrast, even when light is falling on the screen. These new screens perform much better in daylight conditions than the traditional screens.

The first to undergo the conversion will be the Dell Latitude E-series, and the Dell precision M-series. These lines will start shipping the LED versions of the laptops from December this year. By the end of next year, Dell hopes to offer as much as 80 per cent of its laptop range with LED lit screens. By the end of 2010, Dell hopes to convert all of its laptops to the LED screens. These new laptops will use only 43 per cent of the power used in current screens, and being free of environmental toxins, are totally recyclable. The LED screens



also considerably extends the life of the battery, with nearly twice the amount of battery runtime as with typical displays. This is not a compromise in technology, as most green solutions tend to be, instead it is a leap forward.

Dell's other green efforts include the retailing the environmentally friendly PC – Energy Star 4.0, participating in the green grid (along with IBM, Microsoft, Sun, HP and Intel) to standardise benchmarking of processor performance per watt, a payment system that makes every laptop purchase carbon-neutral by donating money to environmental organisations, and a free recycling program for all Dell machines. Dell also introduced the term 'Re-Generation' at the 2007 world environment day, like the 'generation x' for re-users, reducers and recyclers.

GOOGLE GETS COMPETITION

Yahoo! Amps Up Its Ad System

Following close on the heels of the Google deal that made everyone tremble because Yahoo! and Google would achieve an overwhelming